DISEC

Oakridge JMUN 2026

Disarmament and International Security Committee

Agenda: Deliberating Upon Strengthening the Global Nuclear Non-Proliferation Regime in the Face of Emerging Security Challenges

CARKIA
Jubilee Hills | HiTech City | Financial District

CONTENTS

1. Letter from the Executive Board 4

2. MUN Rules Of Procedure (ROP) 6

- 1. Roll Call 6
- 2. Setting the Agenda 6
- 3. Speakers' List 6
- 4. Points 6
- 5. Motions 7
- 6. Yields 7
- 7. Caucuses 7
- 8. Draft Resolutions and Amendments 7
- 9. Voting 8

3. Important Points to Remember 8

- 3.1 Procedure 8
- 3.2 Foreign Policy 8
- 3.3 Role of the Executive Board 8
- 3.4 Nature of Source and Evidence 9

4. Introduction to the Committee 9

- 4.1 Overview of DISEC 10
- 4.2 Membership 10
- 4.3 Functions and Past Work 10
- 4.4 Powers Under the Charter 11

5. Committee Mandate 11

- 5.1 Primary Mandates of DISEC 12
- 5.2 What Delegates Can and Cannot Do 12

6. Agenda Overview 12
6.1 Introduction to the Agenda 12
6.2 Key Terms 13
7. Historical Background 14
8. The Treaty at the Centre: The NPT 15
8.1 The NPT Bargain 15
8.2 Where the Treaty Strains 16
9. The Wider Non-Proliferation Regime 16
10. Who Has What, Today 18
11. Emerging Security Challenges 19
11.1 North Korea 19
11.2 Iran 19
11.3 War and Nuclear Facilities 19
11.4 The Collapse of Arms Control 20
11.5 AUKUS and Naval Reactors 20
11.6 Technology and New Domains 20
11.7 Non-State Actors 20
12. Stakeholder and Bloc Analysis 20
13. Past UN Action 21
14. Research Guidance 22
15. Questions a Resolution Must Answer (QARMA) 22

1. Letter from the Executive Board

Greetings Delegates,

It is time to switch from your routine school life and step into the shoes of a diplomat, something most of us have dreamt about at least once. It gives us immense pleasure to welcome you to this simulation of the Disarmament and International Security Committee (DISEC), the First Committee of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA-DISEC), at OAKJMUN 2026. We look forward to an enriching and rewarding experience.

The agenda for the session is "Deliberating Upon Strengthening the Global Nuclear Non-Proliferation Regime in the Face of Emerging Security Challenges." We are delighted to facilitate this committee, which addresses one of the most significant global issues today. As your Executive Board, we are committed to making sure you not only learn but also enjoy the process. Please remember the gravity of the topic and approach it with the seriousness and care it deserves. We hope you have already started your initial research on the agenda. Grasp the committee's scope early: while discussion on this agenda may be broad, the committee's decisions cannot address issues that fall outside its purview.

This guide is meant to shed some light on the composition and working of the committee. We must caution you, though, that it is only a helpful tool and should not be the whole of your research. Although the Executive Board expects the debate to take a certain path, we would greatly value delegates bringing other perspectives and approaches to the table. The Executive Board is there to facilitate discussion; substantive debate comes from you. Unless we are ruling on points of order, we will not express our opinions on the topics.

We would like you to be familiar with the Rules of Procedure, but please do not treat them as rigid and unalterable. If the committee would like changes to the rules to improve debate, discuss it among yourselves and inform the Executive Board quickly. We expect you to analyse the data you find, not just recite it. The committee will be fast-paced, which should be a welcome change from the typical MUN debate. Never be scared to make unconventional suggestions; if you lobby well, your peers will take them seriously. We expect delegates to balance procedural and substantive expertise.

Finally, we appeal to all delegates to prepare sincerely and to help make this a positive learning experience for everyone. Please get in touch with us if you have any questions or concerns.

A small note on us: we also started doing MUNs back in school, so we understand that many of these terms might appear alien or zoom past you like bouncers. We are here to help you navigate the battlefield of blazing warheads!

All the Best!

Executive Board | UNGA-DISEC

2. MUN Rules Of Procedure (ROP)

1. Roll Call

- The Chair calls on each country to declare if they are "Present" or "Present and Voting." It refers to the voting procedure on the Draft Resolution, where a delegate can vote "Yes", "No", or opt to "Abstain".
- If "Present and Voting," the delegate cannot abstain from voting. If the delegate chooses to respond with "Present", they may answer with "Present and Voting" on subsequent days, but this is not permissible for "Present and Voting" as this reply must be used consistently from that point forth.

2. Setting the Agenda

- Delegates motion to set the agenda, followed by a formal debate on which topic to discuss first. This motion requires a simple majority to pass.

3. Speakers' List

- After passing a motion to enter formal debate, delegates are placed on a speakers' list to make formal speeches. Time limits are set, and the Chair calls on delegates to speak in order.
- A delegate must raise their placard if they wish to add their name to this list. They can be on this list only once on any occasion.

4. Points

- **Point of Order:** To correct a procedural error by the Chair.
- **Point of Personal Privilege:** For personal discomfort (e.g., if the room is too cold, or if a fellow delegate cannot be heard).
- **Point of Inquiry:** To ask questions about discussion or statements in committee.
- **Point of Parliamentary Inquiry:** To ask questions with regard to the Rules of Procedure.

5. Motions

- **Motion to Suspend the Meeting:** To break for caucuses or adjourn the session.
- **Motion to Close Debate:** Ends the discussion on a topic and moves to voting. Requires a two-thirds majority.
- **Motion to Table the Topic:** Postpones debate on a topic. Requires a majority vote.

6. Yields

- **Yield to the Executive Board:** A delegate yields their remaining time from their speech to the Executive Board. It is to be used as they see fit.
- **Yield to Another Delegate:** A delegate yields their remaining time for another delegate to speak. (This delegate's permission must be sought beforehand.)
- **Yield to Points of Information:** A delegate yields their remaining time to Points of Information to the committee.
- **Yield to Comments:** A delegate yields their remaining time to comments from the committee.

7. Caucuses

- **Moderated Caucus:** The Chair controls the speaking order with shorter, focused speeches. The topic selected is a narrowed version of the agenda, chosen by the delegate who proposed the moderated caucus.
- **Unmoderated Caucus:** Informal discussion among delegates not under the moderation of the Executive Board.

8. Draft Resolutions and Amendments

- Delegates collaborate to create draft resolutions, which are formal solutions to the discussed issue.
- **Friendly Amendments:** Accepted by all sponsors without a vote.
- **Unfriendly Amendments:** Need to be voted on to be added.

9. Voting

- **Procedural Votes:** Includes motions and amendments; all members must vote.
- **Substantive Votes:** For resolutions and unfriendly amendments; only "Present and Voting" delegates may vote, and abstentions are allowed.

3. Important Points to Remember

A few aspects delegates should keep in mind while preparing:

3.1 Procedure

Procedural rules exist to keep debate organised and efficient. The committee will follow the UNA-USA Rules of Procedure. The Executive Board will be fairly strict with them, but the discussion of the agenda remains the main priority, so do not hold back your statements out of hesitation about procedure.

3.2 Foreign Policy

Following your country's foreign policy is the most important aspect of a Model UN conference. It is what separates Model UN from other debating formats. Violating your country's foreign policy without adequate reason is one of the worst mistakes a delegate can make.

3.3 Role of the Executive Board

The Executive Board is appointed to facilitate debate. The committee decides the direction and flow of debate. Delegates make up the committee, so they should present their opinions and stances freely. The Executive Board may, however, put forward questions or ask for clarifications at any time to further the debate and test participants.

3.4 Nature of Source and Evidence

This Background Guide is meant solely for research purposes and must not be cited as evidence during the conference. Evidence to substantiate statements made in formal debate is acceptable from the following sources:

- **United Nations:** Documents and findings by the United Nations or any related UN body are held as credible proof to support a claim or argument.
- **Multilateral Organisations:** Documents from international organisations such as the OIC, NATO, SAARC, BRICS, EU, ASEAN and the International Court of Justice may also be presented as credible sources.
- **Government Reports:** These can be used in the same way as reports from state-operated news agencies and may, in all circumstances, be denied by another country.
- **Reuters:** Any Reuters article that clearly mentions, or contradicts, the fact being stated by a delegate in committee.
- **State-operated News Agencies:** These reports can be used in support of or against the state that owns the agency. If credible or substantial enough, they can be used for or against any country, but in that case may be denied by any other country in committee. Examples include RIA Novosti (Russian Federation) and Xinhua News Agency (People's Republic of China).

Please Note

Reports from NGOs working with UNESCO, UNICEF and other UN bodies will be accepted. Under no circumstances will sources like Wikipedia, or newspapers like The Guardian or the Times of India, be accepted as evidence. Delegates are still free to quote or cite any source they see fit as part of their statements.

4. Introduction to the Committee

So this segment is what we call "know the devil and the fear is half gone." We know we have to work a little on our humour, but we promise it will not affect our ability to teach you a little more about this topic than your political science book!

4.1 Overview of DISEC

The Disarmament and International Security Committee (DISEC) was established in 1945 and serves as the First Committee of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA). As set out in Chapter IV, Article 11 of the Charter of the United Nations (download it, print it, learn it: this is your MUN bible), DISEC's core working principle is the maintenance of international peace and security. To that end, it may consider the principles governing disarmament and the regulation of armaments, discuss any question that may pose a threat, immediate or not, to international peace and security, and call the attention of the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) to situations that may threaten international peace and security. None of these responsibilities limit the general scope of the UNGA, and by extension DISEC, set out in Article 10 of the Charter.

UNGA-DISEC works closely with the United Nations Disarmament Commission and the Conference on Disarmament in Geneva, Switzerland. It is based at UN Headquarters in New York, where it usually meets once a year for about four to five weeks.

4.2 Membership

All member states of the United Nations are members of UNGA-DISEC, which currently stands at 193 (yes, even the ones you wonder about, and sadly not the ones you wish had made the cut "yet"). The UNGA may also grant observer status to entities and international organisations, as currently held by Palestine and the Holy See. Only full members vote on resolutions; in this committee, observers may vote on procedural matters only (sorry, no voting during documentation, we will explain how it works).

4.3 Functions and Past Work

UNGA-DISEC was established to oversee the actions of national and non-state actors and to review situations whose urgency does not attract the attention of the Security Council. (Wondering what non-state actors are? Anything not backed by a government, for example terrorist organisations like Al-Qaeda. But think: are they really never backed by a state?)

In the past, UNGA-DISEC resolutions have dealt with a wide range of threats to global peace and carried out a wide range of functions: establishing new commissions, as the very first resolution did in 1946 when it set up a commission to deal with the

problems raised by the discovery of atomic energy; and paving the way for treaties, as in 2017, when the General Assembly's mandate led to the negotiation of the Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons.

If necessary, the UNGA can "unite for peace" under Resolution 377 A. If a lack of unanimity among the five permanent members stops the Security Council from performing its primary responsibility, the UNGA shall consider the matter immediately and may make recommendations, including the use of armed force, if a two-thirds majority is reached.

4.4 Powers Under the Charter

All resolutions passed by this committee are non-binding and must be framed as recommendations to the 193 member states. As a subsidiary organ of the General Assembly (authorised under Article 22), DISEC retains the powers and responsibilities of the General Assembly set out in Chapter IV of the Charter, including:

- **Article 10:** "make[ing] recommendations to the Members of the United Nations or to the Security Council or to both on any such questions or matters."
- **Article 11(2):** "discuss[ing] any questions relating to the maintenance of international peace and security brought before it..."
- **Article 11(3):** "call[ing] the attention of the Security Council to situations which are likely to endanger international peace and security."
- **Article 14:** "recommend[ing] measures for the peaceful adjustment of any situation..."

5. Committee Mandate

You might be wondering what this fancy term is. A mandate is what a committee can and cannot discuss. You cannot expect a tea vending machine to serve pizza, can you? (You can expect it, but it really should not happen.) In short, anything that relates to disarmament (giving up arms) and threats to international security (not just the security of your own nation) is within this committee's mandate.

5.1 Primary Mandates of DISEC

1. **Establishing General Principles:** Formulating general principles of cooperation for the maintenance of international peace and security.
2. **Disarmament and Regulation of Armaments:** Developing principles governing disarmament and the regulation of armaments.
3. **Recommendations:** Making recommendations to UN member states and the Security Council regarding these principles.
4. **Proposing Topics for the Security Council:** Suggesting specific topics for the Security Council's consideration, although DISEC does not directly influence the Council's decision-making.
5. **Collaborating with UNODA:** Working with the United Nations Office for Disarmament Affairs to support disarmament initiatives at every level, including nuclear weapons, other weapons of mass destruction and conventional weapons.
6. **Norm-Setting Support:** Providing substantive support to norm-setting within the General Assembly to further disarmament initiatives.

5.2 What Delegates Can and Cannot Do

Delegates must not overstep and discuss issues outside the committee's mandate. That said, disarmament discussions can overlap with areas such as human rights, and the Executive Board will allow some flexibility to accommodate such overlaps where needed. DISEC plays a crucial role in fostering international dialogue and cooperation on disarmament and security, and every clause you write should reflect that role: realistic recommendations, not binding orders.

6. Agenda Overview

6.1 Introduction to the Agenda

Here is a slightly uncomfortable fact to start with: the world holds roughly 12,000 nuclear warheads, and about nine in ten of them belong to just two countries. The rules that stop that number from growing, and stop these weapons spreading into new hands, are what diplomats call the nuclear non-proliferation regime. It is not one treaty. It is a patchwork of treaties, inspections, export rules and, let's be honest, a fair amount of political trust.

That trust is being tested. Arms control agreements between the biggest powers are running out. A few states have crossed the nuclear line outside the rules. New technologies, from cyber tools to hypersonic missiles, are blurring old assumptions about how deterrence works. And many non-nuclear states feel that the nuclear-armed ones keep asking others for restraint while offering very little disarmament themselves.

This is the space your committee is stepping into. The word "strengthening" in the agenda matters. Nobody in the room is being asked to invent a new world order. The question is where the existing system is weakest, and what practical steps can patch those weak spots without breaking the bargain that holds the whole thing together.

> **A Note for Delegates**
>
> Your job in DISEC is not to solve nuclear weapons. It is to find realistic, agreeable steps that a wide range of countries, nuclear and non-nuclear, could actually sign up to.

6.2 Key Terms

- **Horizontal vs. vertical proliferation:** More countries getting nuclear weapons is horizontal proliferation. Countries that already have them building more or better ones is vertical proliferation. The regime was built mostly around the first, but many states insist the second matters just as much.
- **Safeguards and the Additional Protocol:** Inspections and accounting checks run by the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) to confirm nuclear material is not being diverted to weapons. The Additional Protocol gives inspectors wider access, including to undeclared sites. It is voluntary, which is a big part of the debate.
- **Enrichment and reprocessing:** The "sensitive" technologies. Enrichment raises the share of uranium-235: a little makes reactor fuel, a lot makes a bomb. Reprocessing separates plutonium from spent fuel. Both have civilian uses, which is exactly what makes them hard to police.
- **Negative security assurances:** Promises by nuclear-armed states not to use or threaten to use nuclear weapons against non-nuclear states. Many states want these to be legally binding.

- **Nuclear-weapon-free zone (NWFZ):** A regional agreement in which states commit not to develop or host nuclear weapons.

7. Historical Background

The story of non-proliferation is one of fear, bargaining and a handful of very near misses. The table below covers the moments you are most likely to need in debate.

Year	What happened
1945	The first nuclear test in New Mexico is followed within weeks by the bombings of Hiroshima and Nagasaki. The UN is founded that year, and its first General Assembly resolution (1946) sets up a commission to deal with atomic energy.
1957	After President Eisenhower's 1953 "Atoms for Peace" speech, the IAEA is created to spread peaceful nuclear technology while watching for military use.
1962	The Cuban Missile Crisis: thirteen days that came uncomfortably close to nuclear war. It pushes the superpowers towards talking, and towards the idea of a treaty.
1968	The NPT opens for signature. The bargain: no weapons for most, disarmament talks for the few, peaceful energy for all. It enters into force in 1970.
1974	India's "peaceful nuclear explosion" shows that civilian technology can be turned to weapons. The Nuclear Suppliers Group is formed in 1975 to tighten exports.
1991–94	The Soviet Union collapses. Belarus, Kazakhstan and Ukraine return Soviet-era weapons to Russia; Ukraine receives assurances in the 1994 Budapest Memorandum. South Africa dismantles its own bombs.
1995	The NPT is extended indefinitely, alongside a resolution on a Middle East zone free of weapons of mass destruction that remains unfulfilled.
1998	India and Pakistan carry out nuclear tests weeks apart. Both remain outside the NPT.

2003	North Korea announces its withdrawal from the NPT and conducts its first nuclear test in 2006.
2015	The Iran nuclear deal (JCPOA) limits Iran's programme in exchange for sanctions relief. The US withdraws in 2018, and Iran gradually steps away from the limits.
2017	122 states adopt the Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons (TPNW). It enters into force in 2021 with no nuclear-armed state on board.
2022	Russia's invasion of Ukraine brings open nuclear signalling and new fears about the safety of nuclear plants in a war zone.
2026	New START, the last treaty limiting US and Russian long-range forces, reaches its scheduled end in February, and the NPT Review Conference meets in New York. Check what has happened since.

8. The Treaty at the Centre: The NPT

8.1 The NPT Bargain

The Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons opened for signature in 1968 and entered into force in 1970. It is one of the most widely joined arms control treaties ever, with 191 states parties. Only India, Israel, Pakistan and South Sudan have never joined, and North Korea announced its withdrawal in 2003.

The treaty works as a three-way bargain. Non-nuclear states promise not to build weapons. The five recognised nuclear-weapon states (those that tested before 1 January 1967: the US, Russia, the UK, France and China) promise to work towards disarmament. And everyone gets access to peaceful nuclear technology.

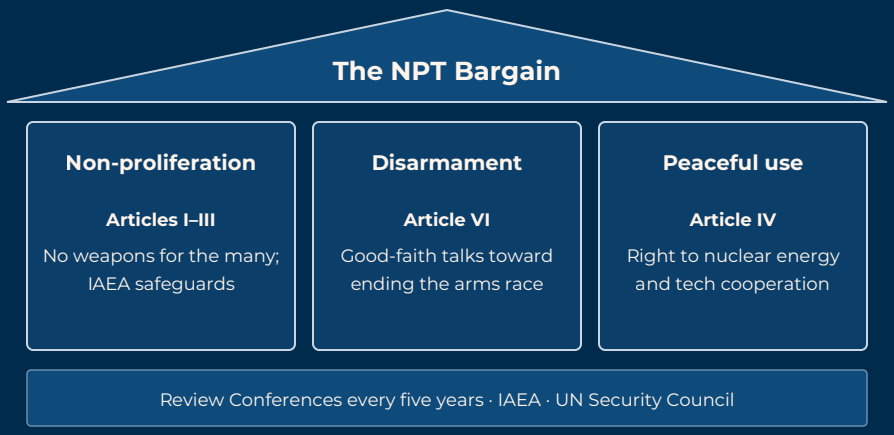


Figure 1: The three pillars of the NPT

8.2 Where the Treaty Strains

- **Article VI** commits states to negotiate "in good faith" on disarmament, but sets no deadline and no method. Many non-nuclear states feel this promise has been left largely unkept.
- **Article IV** guarantees the right to peaceful nuclear energy, yet nobody agrees on how far that right extends when it comes to enrichment and reprocessing.
- **Article X** lets a state leave on three months' notice. There is no clear penalty, and no agreed rule about what happens to equipment and material acquired while a member.
- **Review Conferences** are held every five years. Several recent ones ended without an agreed final document, which says something about the mood.

9. The Wider Non-Proliferation Regime

The NPT does not stand alone. Think of it as the hub of a web, with other institutions and agreements doing specific jobs around it.

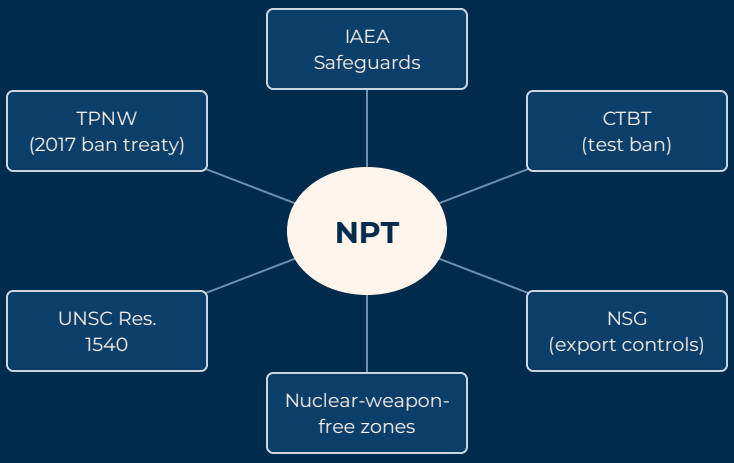


Figure 2: The institutions and agreements around the NPT

- **IAEA:** The UN-linked watchdog in Vienna. It inspects declared nuclear material and reports to its Board of Governors and, where needed, the Security Council.
- **CTBT:** Bans all nuclear explosions. Adopted in 1996 but not yet in force, because several key states have not ratified it. A de facto testing moratorium mostly holds.
- **Nuclear Suppliers Group:** A group of supplier states that sets export guidelines for nuclear and dual-use goods.
- **Nuclear-weapon-free zones:** Regional zones in Latin America, the South Pacific, Africa, Southeast Asia and Central Asia. Together they cover a large part of the globe.
- **UN Security Council Resolution 1540:** Adopted in 2004, it requires all states to prevent non-state actors from obtaining weapons of mass destruction.
- **TPNW:** The 2017 ban treaty. Backed by many non-nuclear states, rejected by every nuclear-armed state and most of their allies. That split runs straight through the committee room.

These pieces overlap and sometimes pull in different directions. A good delegate learns which ones their country has joined, and which ones it has quietly avoided.

10. Who Has What, Today

The numbers below are rounded estimates for early 2025 from the Federation of American Scientists. Sources differ and exact figures are state secrets, so cite them with care.

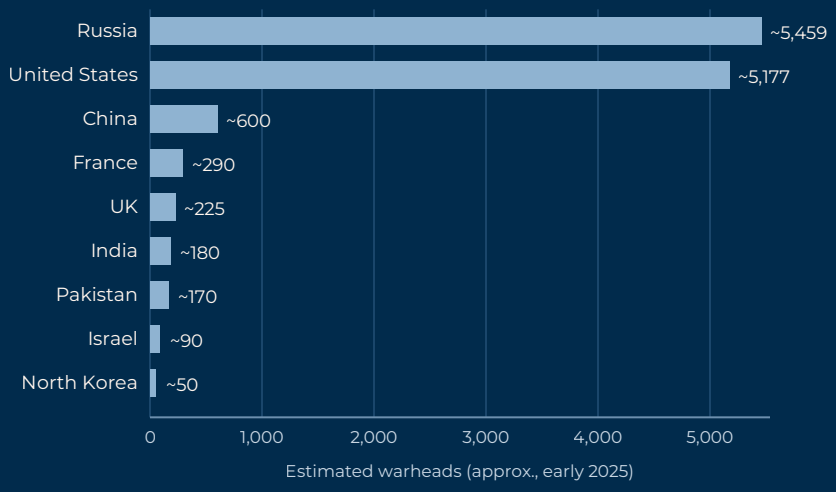


Figure 3: Estimated nuclear warheads by country (approximate)

Country	Worth knowing
Russia	Largest stockpile, including many non-strategic weapons. Nuclear signalling has been part of its messaging since 2022.
United States	Modernising all three legs of its forces. Extends deterrence to allies in NATO and Asia.
China	Fastest-growing arsenal. Has not joined arms control talks and points to the far larger US and Russian numbers.
France / UK	Independent deterrents, both largely submarine-based. The UK has raised its planned warhead ceiling.
India / Pakistan	Neither is an NPT member. Their arsenals are tied to their rivalry with each other, and to China in India's case.
Israel	Has never confirmed or denied having nuclear weapons. Not an NPT member.

North Korea	Withdrew from the NPT and has declared itself a nuclear state. Continues missile development.

Two Things Stand Out

Russia and the US hold most of the world's stockpile, and China's arsenal is growing quickly. That is why many states now argue that arms control can no longer be a two-player game.

11. Emerging Security Challenges

This section is the heart of your agenda. Each challenge below tests the regime in a different way, and your resolution will probably need to speak to more than one.

11.1 North Korea

The clearest case of a state leaving the NPT and building weapons. It has tested six times and keeps developing longer-range missiles. Sanctions exist, but unity in the Security Council on enforcing them has weakened. Delegates should ask what tools remain besides sanctions, and how to reopen diplomacy.

11.2 Iran

Iran is an NPT member whose enrichment levels and limited IAEA access have raised alarm, especially since the JCPOA broke down. Military strikes on its nuclear sites in 2025 and the return of UN sanctions later that year raise hard questions about verification and about the legality of force against safeguarded facilities. Check the latest developments before the conference.

11.3 War and Nuclear Facilities

Fighting around Ukraine's Zaporizhzhia plant put reactors at risk and raised the question of how nuclear sites should be protected during conflict. Add open nuclear threats to the picture, and the idea that nuclear weapons sit somehow outside ordinary war planning starts to look shaky.

11.4 The Collapse of Arms Control

The INF Treaty ended in 2019, the US left the Open Skies Treaty, and New START reached its scheduled end in 2026. With few limits or inspections left, states risk guessing at each other's plans, which is exactly when arms races begin. China's growth adds a third major player to what used to be a two-sided game.

11.5 AUKUS and Naval Reactors

Under AUKUS, Australia is to receive nuclear-powered submarines. That means nuclear material leaving safeguards for naval use, which the NPT allows through an exemption but which no non-nuclear state has used this way before. Critics fear it sets a precedent; supporters say the arrangements will be strict.

11.6 Technology and New Domains

Cyber attacks on command systems, AI in early-warning decisions, hypersonic missiles that shorten decision time, and anti-satellite weapons that could blind warning systems all raise the risk of miscalculation. There are almost no agreed norms for any of it yet.

11.7 Non-State Actors

Terrorist groups getting hold of nuclear or radioactive material is a low-probability, high-impact danger. Resolution 1540 and the Convention on the Physical Protection of Nuclear Material help, but implementation is patchy.

12. Stakeholder and Bloc Analysis

Use these as starting points, then read your own country's statements in the General Assembly and at NPT Review Conferences. Blocs are never perfectly united.

Group	General position
Nuclear-weapon states under the NPT (US, Russia, UK, France, China)	Prefer a step-by-step approach to disarmament that protects "strategic stability." Stress the non-proliferation duties of others, resist binding timelines and reject the TPNW. They disagree sharply with each other on Ukraine, Iran and missile defence, so do not treat them as one voice.

Non-nuclear states under a nuclear umbrella (NATO members, Japan, South Korea, Australia)	Rely on allies' deterrence for their security. Support the NPT strongly and want tougher action on violators, but are cautious about disarmament steps that could weaken their protection.
Non-Aligned Movement and the Global South	Push hard on Article VI, want timelines and legally binding negative security assurances, and defend the "inalienable right" to peaceful nuclear technology without extra conditions.
NWFZ members and TPNW supporters	Argue that nuclear weapons are inhumane and destabilising and should be outlawed. Many are frustrated that the NPT's disarmament pillar feels stuck.
States outside the NPT (India, Israel, Pakistan)	Reject the NPT's split between "haves" and "have-nots." Each has its own security logic, and regional dynamics in South Asia and the Middle East shape everything they say.

13. Past UN Action

Before drafting anything, know what already exists. A resolution that simply repeats old commitments will not impress a chair. One that builds on them will.

- **UNGA Resolution 1(I), 1946:** Created a commission on atomic energy, the first step in the UN's nuclear work.
- **UNSC Resolution 1540 (2004):** Recognised that non-proliferation is a matter of international peace and security, and allowed the Council to act on violations.
- **UNSC Resolution 1718 (2006):** Sanctions on North Korea after its nuclear and missile tests, later tightened by further resolutions.
- **UNSC Resolution 2231 (2015):** Endorsed the Iran nuclear deal in 2015. Its provisions have since been contested.
- **First Committee resolutions:** Each year the First Committee passes dozens of resolutions on nuclear issues, from test bans to security assurances. Read the recent voting records; they tell you exactly which states will back which language.

Also study the outcome documents of past NPT Review Conferences, especially the 1995 package, the 2000 "13 practical steps" and the 2010 action plan. Delegates often cite them as agreed language that can be reused.

14. Research Guidance

All of these are free and reliable. Start with the first three.

- Text of the NPT and Review Conference documents (UN Office for Disarmament Affairs, disarmament.unoda.org)
- IAEA annual Safeguards Implementation Report and Board of Governors statements (iaea.org)
- SIPRI Yearbook: Armaments, Disarmament and International Security (sipri.org)
- Federation of American Scientists, Status of World Nuclear Forces (fas.org)
- Arms Control Association country fact sheets (armscontrol.org)
- UNGA First Committee resolutions and voting records from recent sessions

Before You Cite Anything

This field moves fast. Iran's status, what has replaced New START, and the outcome of the 2026 NPT Review Conference all need checking against up-to-date sources before the conference. Treat this guide as your map, not your last word.

15. Questions a Resolution Must Answer (QARMA)

Use these questions to shape your working papers. A strong resolution answers several of them with concrete, realistic clauses.

1. How can the NPT's three pillars be rebalanced so that non-nuclear states feel disarmament is moving, and nuclear-armed states feel safe enough to take part?
2. Should the Additional Protocol become the universal safeguards standard, and how can states be encouraged, rather than forced, to adopt it?

3. What consequences, if any, should follow when a state withdraws from the NPT under Article X or is found in non-compliance?
4. How can the international community respond to nuclear threats and rhetoric linked to active conflicts without escalating them?
5. What can be done to keep arms control alive between the largest arsenals, and how might China and others be brought into the conversation?
6. How should the regime treat enrichment and reprocessing technology: tighter multilateral controls such as fuel banks, or protecting national rights?
7. How can naval nuclear propulsion arrangements such as AUKUS be handled so that safeguards are not weakened?
8. What role should cyber, AI and space-based systems have in nuclear command and control, and are new norms or confidence-building measures needed?
9. How can nuclear material and facilities be better protected from theft, sabotage and terrorism, including in war zones?
10. What steps could bring the CTBT into force, and should testing moratoria be reinforced in the meantime?
11. Can the TPNW and the NPT be seen as complementary? What bridges could reduce the divide between their supporters?
12. How can peaceful nuclear cooperation and technical assistance be expanded for developing states without raising proliferation risks?